

FOR MAC • TAKES ABOUT 10 MINUTES, MOSTLY WAITING

# Talk instead of type.

Whisper Flow is a free dictation app for your Mac: hold a key, speak, and your words appear typed wherever your cursor is — email, Slack, docs, anything. It's a private alternative to apps like Wispr Flow.

- 100% private — runs entirely on your Mac, nothing you say is ever sent anywhere

## 1 CHECK YOU'RE ON THE RIGHT KIND OF MAC

### Apple silicon only (M1, M2, M3 or M4)

Click the Apple menu (top-left) → About This Mac. If it says Chip: Apple M1/M2/M3/M4, you're good. If it says Intel, this won't run — let Niall know and stop here.

## 2 INSTALL OLLAMA (THE ENGINE THAT TIDIES UP YOUR TEXT)

This is a free, well-known tool that runs small AI models on your own Mac. Whisper Flow uses it to clean up filler words and punctuation — still all on your machine, no internet involved.

### Download and open Ollama

Go to [ollama.com/download/mac](https://ollama.com/download/mac) and click

### Download for macOS

. Open the downloaded file and drag the Ollama icon into your Applications folder, then open Ollama from there. A small llama icon appears near the top-right of your screen (menu bar) — leave it running.

### Download the language model (one-time, ~2GB)

Open

### Terminal

: press  Space, type Terminal, press Enter. Paste the line below in (right-click → Paste, or  V) and press Enter:

```
ollama pull llama3.2:3b
```

It'll show a progress bar. Once it says success, this step is done for good — you won't need Terminal again after this.

### 3 DOWNLOAD AND INSTALL WHISPER FLOW

#### Get the app

[Download Whisper Flow](#)

Double-click the downloaded `WhisperFlow.zip` to unzip it, then drag `WhisperFlow.app` into your

#### **Applications**

folder.

#### **First time only: macOS will warn you**

This app isn't from the App Store, so macOS shows a warning the first time. Here's how to open it anyway:

- **Control-click**  
(or right-click) `WhisperFlow.app` in Applications, then choose **Open**
- A dialog appears saying it's from an unidentified developer — click **Open** again

You only need to do this once. After that it opens normally.

### 4 GRANT TWO PERMISSIONS

macOS will ask for these the first time you use it — both are required for Whisper Flow to work.

#### **Accessibility**

Lets Whisper Flow "type" your words into whatever app you're using, and listen for your hotkey. A prompt appears on first launch — click

#### **Open System Settings**

and turn the toggle on for Whisper Flow. (If you miss it, click the mic icon in your menu bar → Grant Accessibility...)

### Microphone

Needed so it can hear you. A normal "Whisper Flow would like to access the Microphone" prompt appears the first time you dictate — click

**Allow**

.

## 5 HOW TO USE IT

### Start dictating

Click where you want the text to go (an email, a document, any text box), then press  **Command** + **Right ⌥ Option** (the Option key on the right of the spacebar). A small pill appears at the bottom of your screen showing it's listening. Just speak — no need to hold anything down.

### Finish or cancel

When you're done talking,

**press any key**

— your cleaned-up text is typed right where your cursor was. Changed your mind? Press  **esc** instead and nothing is typed. (The key you press is swallowed — it won't end up in your document.)

### Where did the app go?

Whisper Flow lives in your

**menu bar**

(top of the screen, next to the clock/wifi icons) — not the Dock. Click the mic icon there any time to check it's running or see status. It starts automatically every time you log in (you can turn that off from the same menu).

Questions or something not working? Message Niall directly — this is a new tool, so early feedback is genuinely useful.

Whisper Flow runs entirely on your own Mac. Your voice and your text never leave your machine — nothing is uploaded, logged externally, or sent to any company, including VERVE. ← [Back to Flow](#)